Colour frequency and phototherapy

Muted amber or orange light can recall **a candle**, **a fire** or **the evening sun**. It can create a more intimate atmosphere than a brightly lit room. Let us say which of that is **atmosphere** and which is already **treatment**.

And this is exactly where it is good to put **miraculous promises** aside. Orange light is **not a magic lamp** for hormones, mood or chakras.

Why orange light can be pleasant in the evening

Warm orange light contains little of the blue component and tends to be softer than cool white. In the evening it is easy to slow down in it. Less glare, gentler contrasts. For an evening routine, though, it is not only the shade that matters. It also depends on the **brightness**, the length of time the light is on and how much light falls into the eyes. A very bright orange lamp right in front of your face is not automatically more suitable than a weak warm light out of direct view.

What you can try at home

In the evening switch off the large ceiling light and leave a smaller lamp on with a warm, muted light. So that you can see well and do not have to strain your eyes. **What it can bring you.** Less glare and an environment in which it is easier to move from activity to a calmer evening. During the day, on the other hand, do not shut yourself into an orange half-light with the idea that it is beneficial in all circumstances. Daylight and evening quiet have different places in an ordinary day.

Where light is really studied

Blue-light glasses

Glasses that filter blue light (sometimes amber-tinted) are often offered, promising better sleep or less eye strain. A **2023 Cochrane review** summarising 17 randomised trials, however, concluded that the evidence is **inconclusive**. For eye strain from computers there seems to be no short-term benefit, for sleep the effect is unclear. The studies did not assess long-term effects on the retina.

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Skin

In dermatology LEDs of various colours are used. Most data exist for **red** and **near-infrared** light. Yellow light around **590 nm** (sometimes called amber) penetrates the skin only about 0.5 to 2 millimetres and is studied mainly in skin ageing and as an adjunct after laser procedures. An older review from 2015, however, summarises rather small studies and **inconsistent** results. So not even these show that a home orange lamp would improve the skin.

Seasonal depression

For some difficulties light therapy is genuinely used, for example **bright white light** for seasonal depression. The choice of approach is guided by the specific problem, not by a favourite colour, and belongs in the hands of a doctor.

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